



09 – Editorial Calendar

*One calendar governs everything. A single weekly **theme** flows across both daily segments, every clip, the column, and all four platforms — adapted to each, never copy-pasted (see 03). This doc gives you (1) the repeatable weekly template, (2) a fully worked sample month, and (3) the planning cadence.*

Legend: 🌞 Lunch Break Live · 🌙 Evening Show · 📰 Column · ✉ Newsletter · 📺 YouTube · 📷 Instagram · 📝 Substack · 💼 LinkedIn · ✂ clip

1. The repeatable weekly template

Every week has **one theme**. Mon–Thu run the standard two-segment grid; **Friday** swaps in Mailbag + ships the column & newsletter.

Daily output grid (Mon–Fri)

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI
🌞 Lunch Break Live	live take	live take	live take	live take	live take
🌙 Evening Show	Guest A	Guest B	Guest C	Guest D	Mailbag
📺 YouTube	both segments + 2 ✂ Shorts	both + 2 ✂	both + 2 ✂	both + 2 ✂	both + best-of ✂
📷 Instagram	1 Reel + Stories	1 Reel + Stories	Carousel + Reel	1 Reel + Stories	Reel + week recap carousel
📝 Substack	Daily Read note	Note	📰 Column (or Mon)	Note	✉ Newsletter
💼 LinkedIn	text essay	clip + framing	—	text essay	column excerpt

Per-platform weekly quota (targets)

PLATFORM	CADENCE	SOURCE
 YouTube	10 long-form (2/day) + ~10 Shorts	both segments
 Instagram	5 Reels + 2 carousels + daily Stories	clips + quotes
 Substack	1 Column + 1 Newsletter + 2–4 Notes	the writing layer
 LinkedIn	3–4 posts	column excerpts + clips
 Clips	≥6/day → ~30/week	the growth engine (07)

Adaptation, not duplication: the week's theme becomes a YouTube *title*, an IG *hook*, a LinkedIn *thesis*, and a Substack *argument* — phrased for each audience.

2. Worked sample month (illustrative)

A 4-week month showing how themes, guests, and the cross-platform flow stack up. Names are **placeholder archetypes** (05) — swap for real bookings.

WEEK 1 – Theme: *"Who Counts? Voting & Power"*

DAY	☀️ LIVE TAKE	🌙 EVENING GUEST	CLIPS → PLATFORMS	WRITTEN
Mon	The week's voting-rights story	Voting-rights scholar	2 ✂️ → 📺📺 · 📁	Daily Read
Tue	New polling, what it hides	State legislator	2 ✂️ → 📺📺 · 📁 clip	Note
Wed	"The Throughline": history of the franchise	Civil-rights org leader	Carousel → 📺📺 · 2 ✂️	 Column
Thu	Court watch	Election-law expert	2 ✂️ → 📺📺 · 📁 essay	Note
Fri	Mailbag teaser	Mailbag	Best-of ✂️ + 📺 recap	 Newsletter

WEEK 2 – Theme: *"The Economy You Actually Live In"*

DAY	☀️ LIVE TAKE	🌙 EVENING GUEST	CLIPS → PLATFORMS	WRITTEN
Mon	Jobs/inflation read	Labor economist	2 ✂️ → 📺 🎬 · 📁	📰 Column
Tue	"The Receipts": myth-bust a stat	Union organizer	2 ✂️ → 📺 🎬	Note
Wed	Housing & who's locked out	Housing-policy voice	Carousel → 📺 · 2 ✂️	Note
Thu	Wealth gap throughline	Author (new book)	2 ✂️ → 📺 🎬 · 📁	Note
Fri	Mailbag teaser	Mailbag	Best-of ✂️ + 📺 recap	✉️ Newsletter

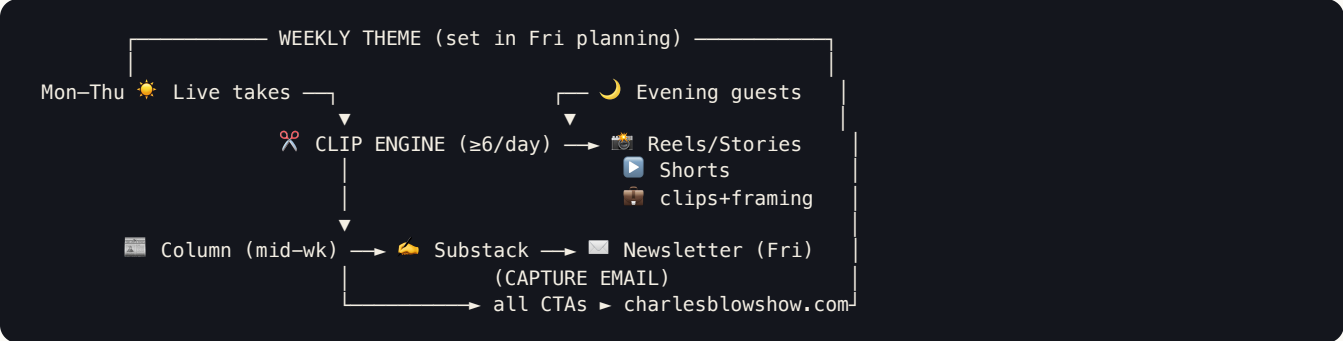
WEEK 3 – Theme: *"Justice & the Courts"* · 🏛️ Monthly Big Interview lands Wed

DAY	☀️ LIVE TAKE	🌙 EVENING GUEST	CLIPS → PLATFORMS	WRITTEN
Mon	SCOTUS/term preview	Legal scholar	2 ✂️ → 📺 🎬 · 📁	📰 Column
Tue	A case that matters	Civil-liberties lawyer	2 ✂️ → 📺 🎬	Note
Wed	Big Interview promo all day	🏛️ BIG INTERVIEW (Senator/Gov)	4 ✂️ → all · 📁 essay	Note + primer
Thu	Reaction to the Big Interview	Reform advocate	2 ✂️ → 📺 🎬	Note
Fri	Mailbag teaser	Mailbag	Best-of ✂️ + 📺 recap	✉️ Newsletter

WEEK 4 – Theme: *"State of Us"* · 🇮🇹 State of the Union(s) + 🗣️ Town Hall (members)

DAY	☀️ LIVE TAKE	🌙 EVENING GUEST	CLIPS → PLATFORMS	WRITTEN
Mon	Month-in-review setup	🇮🇹 State of the Unions special	2 ✂️ → 📺 🎬 · 📁	📰 Column (monthly long read)
Tue	One throughline of the month	Journalist/peer	2 ✂️ → 📺 🎬	Note
Wed	"What Now?" deep dive	🗣️ Roundtable (3 voices)	Carousel + 3 ✂️ → all	Note
Thu	Looking ahead	Rising figure ("Next Up")	2 ✂️ → 📺 🎬 · 📁	Note + Reading List
Fri	🗣️ Town Hall teaser	Mailbag → member Town Hall (live)	Best-of ✂️ + monthly recap carousel	✉️ Newsletter

3. The week's flow (how one theme travels)



4. Planning cadence

WHEN	RITUAL	OUTPUT
Monthly (last Fri)	Theme + guest planning	4 weekly themes, Big Interview booked, tentpoles slotted
Weekly (Fri, 45 min)	Lock next week	Themes confirmed, guests confirmed, column angle, clip targets
Daily (standup)	Execute	The call sheet (08)

Always-on guardrails:

- **Mix ~70% evergreen / 30% news-pegged** so the library ages well; leave Live fully topical.
- **Keep ≥2 banked Evening Shows** so a cancellation never goes dark.
- **Breaking-news override:** any day's theme yields to a major story — Live pivots first, Evening can go rapid-reaction.
- **Vary the guest archetype** day to day (official → scholar → organizer → author) so the grid never feels samey.

5. Suggested tooling

- **Master calendar:** Notion / Airtable database (one row per asset: date, platform, segment, theme, status, owner, link).
- **Scheduling:** Buffer / Later / Metricool for IG + LinkedIn; YouTube + Substack native schedulers.

- **One source of truth:** every clip and post traces back to its segment + theme row, so nothing ships orphaned.

A ready-to-fill Airtable/Notion schema can be generated next if useful — base fields: **Date** · **Day** · **Theme** · **Segment** · **Platform** · **Asset type** · **Hook/Title** · **Owner** · **Status** · **URL** .